## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(b)** well-meaning but patronising | Anxious love. |
| 2 | **(c)** that old age equals incapacity | Ageism. |
| 3 | **(d)** Grandpa said that he had been fooling them all day. | Present perfect continuous becomes past perfect continuous. |
| 4 | **(a)** a gap between belief and truth | Dramatic irony. |
| 5 | **(a)** Mother forgetting the birthday | Young forget too. |
| 6 | **(c)** treating someone as inferior | Condescending. |
| 7 | **(c)** Mother's confident remark about memory | It mocks self-assurance. |
| 8 | **(c)** They love Grandpa but misread his needs | Inference. |
| 9 | **(a)** A doctor who never visits a doctor | Contradiction. |
| 10 | **(a)** emotional maturity | He teaches by humour. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | We know more than Ravi and Mother (1). The gap creates humour and exposes their misjudgement (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Humour makes readers accept the message (1) without feeling lectured (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | By universal images such as a tune and a flower (1). We link them to our own memories (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | It points out the mother's lapse with humour (1). No one is shamed (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | He uses humour (1). He jokes rather than rebukes (1). He teaches and keeps dignity (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Many elders live with children (1). Respect and freedom are issues (1). Humour and talk help (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Mother wishes she remembered the date (1). 'Wish' + past for unreal present (1). It expresses regret (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The family 'cares' for Grandpa (1). He actually looks after their pride and teaches (1). The roles blur (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | The mother is absent (1). Her presence appears in sense images (1). The contrast gives depth (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Metaphor (1). Memory compared to a flowing river (1). It suggests gentle, continuous flow (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Mother's unfounded worry (1). Ravi's secretive following (1). Grandpa's wit (1). The ironic title (1). The lesson on respect (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Theme (1). Structure (1). Imagery (1). Tone and diction (1). Personal response (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Third-person view (1). Dramatic irony (1). Dialogue and humour (1). The twist ending (1). Effect on the theme (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Date (1). Morning plan (1). Noticing Ravi (1). The Vitamin-M joke (1). Reflection (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Reading 'Vitamin-M' as a story about a real vitamin. The 'M' stands for **memory**; the story is humorous and affectionate and is told by a third-person narrator.
- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
- Describing Ravi's secret following as rude or cruel. He hides behind benches and trees because he is worried about Grandpa, so state the motive (concern) along with the action.
- Mixing the poem with the story: 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' is by **Rabindranath Tagore**; its mood is tender and wistful, and the shiuli flower and the tune bring only a faint memory.
- Writing that the speaker of the poem hates or has forgotten his mother. He *cannot remember* her because she is no longer with him, so the feeling is loss, not anger.

- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** absence felt as presence | Presence in absence. |
| 2 | **(c)** Hiding behind a tree, Ravi watched Grandpa. | Hiding... is a participle phrase. |
| 3 | **(b)** Care without respect becomes control. | Message. |
| 4 | **(c)** a series of memories | Paradox. |
| 5 | **(a)** Who Needs Vitamin-M Really? | Relevant. |
| 6 | **(a)** makes readers expect one thing and delivers another | Expectation reversal. |
| 7 | **(a)** restraint and simple images | Quiet tone. |
| 8 | **(c)** an elder whose wit outpaces the family's worry | Summary. |
| 9 | **(b)** his dignity and feelings would be central | Perspective. |
| 10 | **(d)** sensory suggestion | Senses. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | It stands for a quick cure for ageing (1). It shows the wish to fix people instead of respecting them (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Restraint adds dignity (1). Images say more than labels (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | It presents an old man as capable and witty (1). It shows the family's bias as mistaken (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | 'Cannot remember' suggests absence (1) yet the poem fills with remembered feelings (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | She is made a source of irony (1). She is also loving (1). The tone is gentle so judgement is mild (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Short lines slow the pace (1). They sound like quiet thoughts (1). The mood is gentle (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Sound is a tune that lingers in time (1). Smell is immediate and recalls a place (1). Both evoke presence in different ways (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Characters hold wrong beliefs (1). The audience sees the truth (1). Resolution brings laughter (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Memory is the process described (1). The mother is its object (1). Both are central, but memory is the focus (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** For: safety (1). Against: dignity and freedom (1). A balanced approach is best (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Grandpa remembers what matters (1). Mother forgets the birthday (1). Memory is care (1). The poem shows memory as feeling (1). Together they widen the idea (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Opening (1). Elder introduced (1). Conflict (1). Learning moment (1). Ending (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Introduction (1). Grandpa as example (1). Wisdom from experience (1). Our duties (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Humour disarms (1). Sorrow touches (1). The story chooses humour (1). The poem chooses sorrow (1). Both succeed in different ways (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Reading 'Vitamin-M' as a story about a real vitamin. The 'M' stands for **memory**; the story is humorous and affectionate and is told by a third-person narrator.
- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
- Describing Ravi's secret following as rude or cruel. He hides behind benches and trees because he is worried about Grandpa, so state the motive (concern) along with the action.
- Mixing the poem with the story: 'I Cannot Remember My Mother' is by **Rabindranath Tagore**; its mood is tender and wistful, and the shiuli flower and the tune bring only a faint memory.

- Writing that the speaker of the poem hates or has forgotten his mother. He *cannot remember* her because she is no longer with him, so the feeling is loss, not anger.
- Tense errors: *Grandpa **had gone** out without telling anyone* (past perfect), not 'had went'. Plural of child is *children*.

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# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 4: **Vitamin-M; I Cannot Remember My Mother** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

## SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** one is playful, the other is tender | Tone. |
| 2 | **(d)** he sees that his own assumptions were wrong | Learns. |
| 3 | **(d)** suggests faint, uncertain presence | Precise verb. |
| 4 | **(b)** selling someone short | Idiom. |
| 5 | **(b)** each hides what the other already knows | Mutual. |
| 6 | **(a)** Both show how love is carried in small, ordinary things | Link. |
| 7 | **(b)** concessive phrase | Concession. |
| 8 | **(c)** humorous and a gentle rebuke | Mixed. |
| 9 | **(c)** If Mother had remembered, she would have baked a cake. | Had + would have. |
| 10 | **(a)** what we forget and what we treasure reveal our love | Synthesis. |

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | In the story Grandpa's silence about knowing is comic (1). In the poem silence is the absence of the mother (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | He is loyal to Mother and fond of Grandpa (1). He ends up learning the truth for both sides (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | It lives in senses, not facts (1). It returns through small triggers (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Both are shaped by memory (1). One forgets, the other struggles to remember (1). | 1+1 |

## SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Objects become hiding places and clues (1). They give physical comedy (1). The closing joke ties the plot (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Grandpa had been underestimated by the family (1). Focus moves to Grandpa (1). It stresses his experience (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | It shows rather than tells (1). It adds humour (1). It leaves a warm effect (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** It is for safety (1). It involves spying (1). Grandpa's humour makes it forgivable (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Grandpa gave Ravi a book that was about detectives (1). 'That' links the clauses (1). It avoids repetition (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Humour in one, sorrow in the other (1). Both value family bonds (1). Both reflect on time and love (1). | 1+1+1 |

## SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Ravi sees a mission (1). Mother sees a problem (1). The poem's speaker sees the past as a child (1). Each view is partial (1). Together they show love (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** In the story, Mother's care is clear (1). In the poem, love outlasts presence (1). Small things carry it (1). Humour and sorrow show it (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Hearing (1). Smell (1). Sight (1). Association with childhood (1). The mood of longing (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Greeting (1). Examples from the unit (1). Why respect matters (1). What we can do (1). Closing (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

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- Missing the irony: Mother worries that Grandpa may forget his way, but it is Mother who forgot **Grandpa's birthday**. Naming Ravi or Grandpa as the one needing Vitamin-M loses the mark.
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